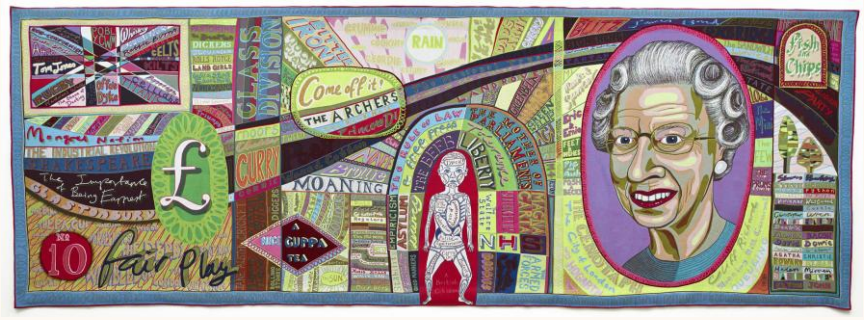
TEACHER MANUAL · ENGLISH · LEVEL B1

Comfort Blanket — Teacher Manual

Grayson Perry's Comfort Blanket: A Portrait of Modern Britain



DURATION	LEVEL	Integrated task
Two 45-min lessons	B1 · National identity	Collage & museum label

Lesson Phases

Lesson 1

Warm-up

Goal: *Activate prior knowledge and introduce the topic.*

- Give each student a Post-it note.
- Without showing Comfort Blanket, ask students to draw as many things as they associate with Britain as possible.
- Briefly discuss as a class and ask who has the most items. (Who has more than…?)
- Reveal Grayson Perry's Comfort Blanket.
- Students identify and count recognisable British symbols they can find in the artwork — use "What do you recognise?"

Orientation

- Introduce the learning goals.

Reading Cycle

Pre-reading

- Read through the exercises collectively – finish the gist exercise.

While Reading

- Students read the article individually.
- Complete the reading comprehension questions.
- Read the text a second time and underline examples of who, which, and that.
- Determine what each pronoun refers to (person or thing), using two different colours.

Post-reading

Goal: *Consolidate understanding and practise grammar.*

- Discuss the reading answers as a class.
- Elicit the rule for relative pronouns.
- Complete exercise 3.4 collectively to consolidate grammar.

Guided Practice

Goal: individual practice to consolidate new knowledge.

- Complete the relative pronoun exercises and correct them

Application (Homework: Collage)

Goal: Apply knowledge and skills in a meaningful context.

- Create a collage representing national identity for a country of their choosing, using colours, shapes, composition, and visual symbols.
- Write a museum label using target vocabulary and relative pronouns.

Lesson 2

Presentation

Goal: Present and justify artistic choices while evaluating different representations of national identity.

- Divide the class into two groups. One group stands next to their collage and museum label as museum guides, while the other group acts as museum visitors.
- Visitors walk around the exhibition in small groups. Each student presents their artwork several times (about 2 minutes per visitor group) and answers questions about their artistic choices.
- After 10–15 minutes, the groups switch roles so that every student has presented their work and visited the exhibition.
- At the end of the gallery walk, each student individually selects four collages they believe should be included in the museum's exhibition "National Identity".
- Conclude with a whole-class reflection on why different students made different selections and how national identity can be represented in multiple ways.

Reflection (Exit Ticket)

Goal: Reflect on different representations of national identity and justify personal choices using relative pronouns.

- Students complete an individual Museum Curator exit ticket before leaving the classroom.

4. Grammar Help – Relative Pronouns

Why do we use relative pronouns?

We use relative pronouns to give extra information about a person or thing without starting a new sentence.

Example
Grayson Perry is an artist. He created Comfort Blanket.
→ Grayson Perry is an artist **who** created Comfort Blanket.

Using a relative pronoun makes your writing clearer, more natural, and less repetitive.

Which relative pronoun do I use?

Relative pronoun	We use it for…	Example
who	people	Grayson Perry is an artist who created Comfort Blanket.
which	animals and things	Comfort Blanket is an artwork which represents Britain.
that	people, animals, and things (less formal)	The symbols that appear in the artwork represent different communities.

Remember!
✓ Use who for people.
✓ Use which for things.
✓ Use that for people or things in most everyday English.

Answer Key

Reading for gist

B — The tapestry celebrates modern Britain as a diverse country where everyone belongs.

Reading for detail

1. He is famous for creating colourful and thought-provoking works of art.

2. The design of a British £10 note.

3. Traditional: e.g. cricket, village greens, gardens, pubs, the countryside. Modern: e.g. Britain's many cultures, languages, and traditions. (Any one valid example each.)

4. Wealth: e.g. "Eton", "Aga", "green wellies" (any two). Working-class: e.g. "boozer", "Blackpool", "allotments" (any two).

5. It means "Don't be silly!" / "I don't believe you." Perry includes it to remind people to question ideas rather than accept them without thinking — and because laughing at ourselves is an important British quality.

6. From a friend whose family escaped from Hungary as refugees in 1956; his friend's mother called Britain her "security blanket".

7. In a citizenship centre, so new British citizens could see it after passing their citizenship test — as a reminder that Britain should be welcoming and protective.

Answer Key – Grammar: Relative Pronouns

3.2 Complete the rules

We use who for people.

We use which for animals and things.

We use that for people, animals, and things (especially in everyday, less formal English).

3.3 Circle the correct relative pronoun, explain why

1. **who —** Grayson Perry, who created the tapestry, is a famous British artist.
Why: *Grayson Perry is a person.*

2. **which —** The tapestry, which is shaped like a £10 note, hangs in a gallery.

Why: *The tapestry is a thing.*

3. **which —** Perry included the phrase "Come off it!", which many British people use every day.

Why: *It refers back to the phrase, which is a thing.*

4. **who —** The Queen, who appears in the middle of the tapestry, looks kind and friendly.

Why: *The Queen is a person.*

5. **which / that —** Britain is a country which/that has many different cultures and traditions.

Why: *Both are correct here — there is no comma, so either is acceptable.*

> **Why isn't that possible in 1, 2, and 4?**
> *Look closely at those sentences: the relative clause sits between commas and simply adds extra, non-essential information (you could remove it and the sentence would still make sense). English does not use that in this kind of clause — only who or which are allowed after a comma. That can only be used in clauses with no commas, where the information is essential to identify who or what is being talked about (as in Q5). This is also why that never follows a comma in the reading text itself.*

3.4 Join the Sentences

Accept which or that unless noted — both are correct in restrictive clauses with no comma.

1. Comfort Blanket is a large textile artwork that/which represents British identity.

2. Perry included Queen Elizabeth II, who is an important British figure. (who — she is a person)

3. The collage contains many symbols that/which represent different communities.

4. Some British people who have multicultural backgrounds may not identify with traditional symbols. (who — refers to people)

5. The students created collages that/which show different ideas about national identity.

6. A museum curator is a person who selects artworks for an exhibition. (who — a person)

3.5 Correct or Rewrite

1. Grayson Perry is an artist who creates colourful artworks.

Mistake: *who for a person, not which.*

2. The symbols that/which appear in the collage represent Britain.

Mistake: *that/which for a thing, not who.*

3. The Queen is a person who is recognised around the world.

Mistake: *who for a person, not which.*

4. The images that/which Perry selected show different parts of British society.

Mistake: *that/which for a thing, not who.*

5. A museum is a place that/which displays artworks.
Mistake: *that/which for a place/thing, not who.*

6. People who/that visit the exhibition may have different opinions.
Mistake: *who/that for people, not which.*

Answer Key – Collage, Museum Label & Exit Ticket

Part 6 – Collage

Open task — there is no single correct answer. Check that students have engaged with several of the listed themes (traditions, history, famous places, food, sports, culture, diversity, modern life, important people, values) and made deliberate visual choices.

Part 7 – Museum Label

Open task (100–150 words). Check for: an explanation of the collage, a description of the symbols used, a clear message, and at least three relative clauses (who, which, that). A sample answer is given below for reference.

Sample answer

This collage represents the Netherlands, a country that combines old traditions with modern innovation. In the middle, I placed a windmill, which symbolises the nation's connection to nature and history. Around it, I added pictures of tulip fields and cyclists, which represent everyday Dutch life. I also included a photo of a football fan, who shows the passion Dutch people have for sport. Bright orange fills the background because orange is the colour that represents national pride during celebrations like King's Day. Together, these symbols show a country that is proud of its past but always looking towards the future.